

A phrasal verb is a verb plus one or two small words (called particles—usually a preposition or adverb) that work together to give a new meaning.

Examples

look + up → look up (to search for information)

I look up new words in the dictionary.

give + up → give up (to stop trying)

Don't give up.

Common Phrasal Verbs (with simple meanings)

wake up – stop sleeping

sit down – take a seat

turn on – switch on

turn off – switch off

carry on – continue

put off – postpone

pick up – lift / learn / collect

run out of – have no more

Types of Phrasal Verbs

Separable (object can come in the middle)

Turn off the light.

Turn the light off.

Inseparable (object cannot separate them)

Look after the baby. Look the baby after.

No object

The plane took off.